

APOCALYPSE NOW?

Are we bidding adieu to civilization as we know it? How we missed our chance to stop the P-virus, and how it's too late now

November 3, 2072

I am anonymous

I've started this retro-style blog, and will keep it "anonymous" because I'm terrified of catching the P-virus. I found the term "anonymous" in an old online poster. It means to not reveal your identity – and yes, I'm aware of how crazy that sounds today. You'll find out why as this blog progresses – if anyone still reads blogs that is. About the P-virus, which is what this blog is really about, did you know that there was a time when only the random stray person would catch the bug. It wasn't terrible or anything; in fact people would go "Wow! They're so lucky!" Most people self-destructed back then after catching the virus, and yet more and more people wanted it, and went out of their way to get infected.

Identifying and managing the disease was easier in the early days. Fewer people had it, they had it for a lot longer, and although the crowds of crazy people trying to get close to them to try and catch the fever were larger, they were easier to manage because it was all in the "real world". Then the internet came along, and the epidemic was uncontrollable. Almost every "first world" citizen, and a growing minority of "third-world" people (whatever happened to the second world, eh?) now had a digital intravenous line direct to the brain, and the virus started spreading like wildfire. That's not all though. There used to be a time when this was a purely human disease. Then cats and dogs started catching the fever as well. More cats than dogs, as history shows, but there was always a stray parakeet, dolphin, tiger, etc., and even an octopus or two that caught it.

November 4, 2072

Indiscriminate attacks

Look, I'm only human. And it may be mean, but honestly, I look at some people who are just so much larger than life and think, "Yeah, they really deserve to get the fever", but for the most part, I sit here thinking "No! Not her/him, anyone but them!" Now don't Unlike me because of that, a person's got to eat you know. Of course viruses are like that. Just as that old HIV disease didn't care about race, bank balance, gender or sexual orientation, this new super bug was indiscriminating as well. It didn't need to be marketed or encouraged, it just spread, and every single one of us ended up either spending all of our time trying to catch it, or if we caught it, making sure we weren't cured. Yes, that actually happens. I should know, I'm a recovering patient, but I'm tempted to stop trying to get re-infected.

November 7, 2072

Wasn't always like this

I've been doing some digging over the past few days – trying to figure out where it began. I've spent many hours online at FB+ and VTube. Did you know FB+ wasn't always owned by Google? And VTube was previously called YouTube, and that wasn't owned by Google earlier either?

When diseases hit us in the past, entire industries were built around trying to cure them. Condom manufacturers capitalised on the HIV epidemic when it raged. Pharmaceutical companies then made billions when the cure was discovered. The P-virus was the opposite. People made billions of Likes (used to

be called "dollars" then; made of paper, they were actually carried around to buy stuff!) by making services such as Facebook (which Google later bought and changed to FB+). Of course back then, watching video on TV and net access were actually done on separate devices, believe it or not. And there was actually an entire industry that made money off getting you to watch its stars on TV, and you couldn't fast forward the video! Those must have been terrible days!

Tip: The forgotten web is chockful of these decrepit sites that say as much. If you have a library subscription, just search for videos that show this "money" on VTube. Use the "Paper money + oldies" keywords, and you'll find a few.

November 9, 2072

Beginning stages

I found a really interesting story in the library today. There was this chap called Bongiovi, who was a famous singer way back when, and chicks loved him and men wanted to be him – or was it the other way around? From the pictures I saw of him, who knows...

Here's the story of how he caught the virus. Bongiovi went out of his way – giving away CDs of his music to all the RJs (radio jockeys) he could find, bribing his way to them with free pizza. Rumour has it that RJs were known carriers back in the day, and every now and then someone would catch the bug from one of them – people caught a lot of things from one another in those days, but it's just the P-virus I'm interested in.

Bongiovi, who later formed a band called Bon Jovi, caught the bug from an RJ